



HEALTHCARE SPANISH

Clinic Visit Phrasebook

Practical Spanish–English phrases for a medical appointment, from check-in to checkout.

A pocket reference for patients, families, and volunteers. Print it, fold it, and bring it to your next visit. Every phrase is paired with a plain note on when to use it.

Reading this phrasebook

Phrases are grouped by the moment you'll need them — scheduling, the exam room, the pharmacy, the billing desk, and asking for help. Each row gives the English, the Spanish, and a short note. Words like *alérgico/a* change with gender: use *-o* if you are male, *-a* if female.

YOU CAN ASK FOR AN INTERPRETER

In many U.S. healthcare settings, providers that receive federal funding are required to offer free language assistance, including interpreters. You do not have to bring your own, and you should never be asked to rely on a child to interpret.

“Quisiera un intérprete, por favor.” — I would like an interpreter, please.

PHRASES

Appointments

ENGLISH	ESPAÑOL	WHEN TO USE IT
I would like to make an appointment.	<i>Quisiera hacer una cita.</i>	Scheduling by phone or at the front desk.
This is my first visit.	<i>Esta es mi primera visita.</i>	New patients usually arrive early for forms.
I need to cancel my appointment.	<i>Necesito cancelar mi cita.</i>	Call early — offices may have a cancellation policy.
Do you have anything earlier?	<i>¿Tiene algo más temprano?</i>	Asking for a sooner date or time.
I'm here for my two o'clock appointment.	<i>Vengo a mi cita de las dos.</i>	Checking in when you arrive.

PHRASES

At the clinic

ENGLISH	ESPAÑOL	WHEN TO USE IT
It hurts here.	<i>Me duele aquí.</i>	Point to the area as you say it.
The pain started three days ago.	<i>El dolor empezó hace tres días.</i>	Providers almost always ask when it began.
I take medication for high blood pressure.	<i>Tomo medicamento para la presión alta.</i>	Bring a list of your medications.
I am allergic to penicillin.	<i>Soy alérgico/a a la penicilina.</i>	State allergies early; swap in your own.
Could you explain that more slowly, please?	<i>¿Podría explicarlo más despacio, por favor?</i>	It is always okay to ask a provider to slow down.

ENGLISH	ESPAÑOL	WHEN TO USE IT
What are the next steps?	<i>¿Cuáles son los siguientes pasos?</i>	A good closing question before you leave.

PHRASES

Pharmacy

ENGLISH	ESPAÑOL	WHEN TO USE IT
I'm picking up a prescription.	Vengo a recoger una receta.	Have your name and date of birth ready.
How many times a day do I take this?	¿Cuántas veces al día tomo esto?	Confirm the dosage before leaving.
Should I take it with food?	¿Debo tomarlo con comida?	Some medicines work best with or without food.
Is there a generic version?	¿Hay una versión genérica?	Generics are usually much less expensive.
I need a refill.	Necesito un resurtido de mi receta.	The label shows how many refills remain.

PHRASES

Insurance & billing

ENGLISH	ESPAÑOL	WHEN TO USE IT
Do you accept my insurance?	¿Aceptan mi seguro?	Ask before the visit; show your card.
How much is the copay?	¿Cuánto es el copago?	The fixed amount you pay at the visit.
Can I get an itemized bill?	¿Me puede dar una factura detallada?	Lists every charge — useful for spotting errors.
Do you offer a payment plan?	¿Ofrecen un plan de pagos?	Many clinics offer plans if you ask.

PHRASES

Asking for help

ENGLISH	ESPAÑOL	WHEN TO USE IT
I would like an interpreter, please.	Quisiera un intérprete, por favor.	You can ask — many facilities must provide one.
Could you write that down for me?	¿Me lo puede escribir, por favor?	Written notes are easier to review later.
I don't understand. Could you repeat that?	No entiendo. ¿Puede repetirlo?	Never leave with unanswered confusion.
Is this information available in Spanish?	¿Esta información está disponible en español?	Many offices have translated materials.

BEFORE YOU GO — A 30-SECOND CHECKLIST

Bring a list of your current medications and doses · Write down your top two or three questions · Bring your insurance card and photo ID · If you take notes, ask the provider to spell or write key words.

This phrasebook supports everyday communication and is not medical advice or a substitute for a professional interpreter. Reviewed by MSC bilingual volunteers.